

add-on, and the kind of system bus it runs on—PCI-Express, dedicated AGP, or the older PCI. Some video-related settings (AGP and PCI) are handled by the BIOS, which have been covered in the BIOS section of this guide, so we won't repeat those here.

3.2 Troubleshooting the Monitor

Modern monitors are especially robust and in most cases, you would upgrade the PC before thinking of changing the monitor. Troubleshooting is relatively easier than the rest of the PC for the simple reason that it is an independent 'box' with no user-serviceable parts.

3.2.1 There's no power to the monitor

Cause 1: There actually is no power being supplied to the monitor.

Solution 1: By far the most common mistake people make is to forget to check the power cables! Sometimes, when monitors are moved around, the power connectors come off or become loose. Plug all cables in tight and check if the power returns. If it is connected to a UPS or stabiliser, check if there is power supply from that unit. Also check the power cable; try using another cable which you know works, to see if power is restored.

Cause 2: If the power cables are plugged in and there is still no power, the problem is more serious. It could mean that a fuse has blown, or there is a more serious problem with the CRT (Cathode Ray Tube).

Solution 2: If the fuse is accessible from the casing of the monitor, replace it and check. If the fuse blows again, or if it still doesn't power up, you have a problem with the electrical circuitry inside the monitor. Your only option is to take it in for repairs.